AI | Expert Insights

COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Senior Director at Innovaccer Views Sierra.ai as a Strategic Asset for Enhancing AI-Driven Customer Experience Operations

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
15 Oct 2026	17 Jul 2026	Customer	AI Interviewer	SIERRA.AI

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covers the organization's evaluation, adoption, and ongoing use of Sierra.ai for AI-driven customer experience operations, including implementation details, ROI metrics, competitive comparisons, and future expansion plans.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Senior Director leading the AI Center of Excellence at a large organization, responsible for evaluating, purchasing, implementing, and managing AI vendors for customer experience operations, with direct oversight of Sierra.ai adoption and integration.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- Views Sierra.ai as a core, strategic investment rather than a tactical solution, with increasing value as use cases expand.
- Believes **Sierra.ai delivers strong efficiency gains and cost savings**, but sees accent recognition and multi-accent support as key areas needing improvement.
- Expresses high confidence in Sierra.ai's roadmap and support, but would consider switching if latency or accent/language support falls behind competitors.

TAKEAWAYS

- Sierra.ai is broadly deployed in production across lead generation, care management, and internal HR functions, primarily in the U.S. healthcare context.
- **Adoption has enabled the organization to scale customer interactions without proportional increases in headcount**, shifting human agents to more complex tasks.
- Key selection factors included solution maturity, humanness of voice, low latency, scalability, and multi-accent support; **Sierra.ai outperformed competitors like Bland.ai and Yellow.ai in these areas**.
- **Current automated resolution rate is about 65%, with 25-30% cost efficiency gains and stable customer satisfaction scores post-**implementation.
- Accent recognition and multi-step validation remain the main technical challenges, and ongoing improvements in these areas are critical for continued investment.

AlphaSense Assistant is AI Generated

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Expert Bio

Senior Director - AI Centre Of Excellence at Innovaccer. The expert can speak to being a customer of Sierra and MS Copilot Studio. The expert is the Senior Director of the AI Centre of Excellence at Innovaccer. The expert is responsible for leading AI strategy, advanced analytics, and data science initiatives across the organization. Prior to this role, the expert served as Director of Data Science and Advanced Analytics at Innovaccer from January 2022 to March 2025, where the expert led AI and analytics programs focused on healthcare technology solutions. Concurrently, the expert was the Co-Founder and CTO of TakeMe2Space from August 2021 to July 2024, where the expert focused on building an AI datacenter in space. The expert can speak to AI infrastructure, healthcare AI applications, advanced analytics, data science leadership, and emerging AI compute technologies.

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Interview Transcript

AI Interviewer 00:00:00

Hi, thank you for your time. Today we'll be discussing how Sierra.ai is being adopted, valued, and compared with alternatives in AI-driven customer experience operations. The conversation will center on your direct experience as a Sierra.ai customer, covering topics like adoption status, use cases, implementation, measurable return on investment, pricing, competitive alternatives, and expansion outlook. I'll aim to keep questions focused and responses of under two minutes each work best. To start, could you tell me about your current role and your responsibilities as they relate to Sierra.ai evaluation, purchase, implementation, or ongoing management?

Expert 00:00:47

I'm currently a senior director for AI. In my current organization, I lead the AI Center of Excellence. I'm solely responsible for decision-making for onboarding any vendors for implementing and embedding AI capabilities into our applications and also championing any AI initiatives within the organization. Specifically, to Sierra AI and voice platforms, the first time we evaluated any platform was in mid-2024, and there were other competitors, of course, we were able to talk about it, but then we narrowed down on using Sierra.ai as a platform of choice for our customer-facing initiatives. Does that help?

AI Interviewer 00:01:28

That's helpful context. Which teams, functions, or regions are involved in Sierra.ai usage or evaluation at your organization?

Expert 00:01:38

There is our lead generation CRM function that uses Sierra.ai. In the U.S. healthcare setup, there are referral scheduling, outbound, and inbound calls from our care management on value-based care. Our care management application, that, of course, uses Sierra.ai. From an internal tooling perspective, our hiring and PX team, that's employee experience team, they also use Sierra.ai for any inbound calls. These are the three functions. The region of operation, it's majority in the U.S. setup. Of course, we have operations in the Middle East, but **we are still expanding** there. All of our voice AI use cases happen within the U.S. setup.

AI Interviewer 00:02:25

What would you say is your current Sierra.ai adoption stage? For example, broad production across those functions, limited production, still in pilot, or something else?

Expert 00:02:38

Once again, please.

AI Interviewer 00:02:40

Of course. Take your time.

Expert 00:02:43

No, I did not get you. Could you please repeat?

AI Interviewer 00:02:46

Of course. What would you say is your current Sierra AI adoption stage? For example, broad production across those three functions, limited production, still in pilot, or something else?

Expert 00:03:00

We are beyond limited production and pilot. We do have broad production implementations. **We've already completed our pilot phase very successfully** with Sierra and, of course, one other platform or vendor platform. It's beyond just limited pilot. We are absolutely in production with this key vendor.

AI Interviewer 00:03:20

Within broad annualized ranges, what is your organization spending with Sierra AI? Are implementation, integration, or ongoing optimization costs billed separately?

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Expert 00:03:32

Our current spend is in the ballpark of $300,000-$700,000 annually. It's in the ballpark. Once again, what was the second question?

AI Interviewer 00:03:42

Are implementation, integration, or ongoing optimization costs billed separately from that figure, or are they included?

Expert 00:03:49

No, this is all included as a platform and then per minute pricing all included in the amount that we are spending. Beyond this number, there are no additional support costs. Of course, we do have internal teams, dev engineers and internal support teams who are aligned to ensure that the product implementations are working fine. Directly to Sierra, this is what we end up spending year on year, at least for now.

AI Interviewer 00:04:16

Within ranges, what is your broader customer experience and contact center technology budget? Roughly, what is your monthly customer interaction volume?

Expert 00:04:25

Roughly, customer interaction volume, because we use it for lead generation heavily and then also some part of refill scheduling, it's roughly between 5,000-10,000 in terms of ballpark monthly customer support volume and inbound calls.

AI Interviewer 00:04:41

What about your broader customer experience and contact center technology budget overall beyond just Sierra AI?

Expert 00:04:50

There is another key vendor that starts with a T, that we use for contact center capabilities. They have an end-to-end platform, where we are spending, if I correctly recollect, I think somewhere between $250,000-$500,000 per year. That is more an end-to-end platform being in place, pretty mature. That's where it adds up, these two vendors together.

AI Interviewer 00:05:18

Let's move to need and selection. What were the primary operational pain points or strategic goals that first triggered your interest in Sierra AI?

Expert 00:05:28

I think the primary idea was the ability to scale, because with the human teams set up, there was only so much that we could scale our contact center, with a lot of inbound, outgoing calls, customer support, inbound patient reach, outbound patient outreach. There was not a lot that we could do in terms of scale. Given voice tech was absolutely maturing in the 2024, 2025 space, we wanted to get in early and ensure we had the right optimizations factored in so that we could not only scale but also scale efficiently. I think these were the two primary reasons. Third being, I think there has been a lot of customer support. There was a lot of market movement towards using AI technology in this space, and hence, we wanted to jump in early.

AI Interviewer 00:06:16

What prior workflows, systems, or tools was Sierra AI intended to replace or supplement when you first brought it in?

Expert 00:06:25

I think some of the primary ones was effectively customer experience and we also worked closely with them to build out our outreach lead generation calling. We have teams working out of APAC who make these outreach calls to customers or prospective customers and, I think, effectively difficult to have consistency, reliability in terms of the questions that are asked, the data that is captured. That is primarily one of the primary reasons we wanted to use Sierra. The other was in the RCM space, particularly for benefits and eligibility.

Typically, when we went into the RCM solution, especially the front office, we were looking at provider teams making these outbound calls to payers or insurances to tally benefits and eligibility criteria for individual patients. That is another area that we wanted to automate with voice pathways because it's very repetitive. You typically ask for identification of the patient, their MRN or their unique ID number in the EHR, and whether they have eligible insurance, whether it's Medicare, Medicaid, and whether they have enough coverage in their insurance left for a particular procedure.

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Those are typically the same repetitive questions, and hence, it is easier to automate it, create a pathway, and have Sierra agents work through this use case. The third is patient access. Think about handling end-to-end appointment booking when a patient calls into the provider office. Also, not just booking, but if you have to reschedule, is there automated follow-ups that need to happen with the patient. I think those are areas where Sierra agents have been used internally.

AI Interviewer 00:08:04

Were those workflows previously handled by human agents, an existing bot or automation tool, or some combination?

Expert 00:08:11

Yes. These are all human agents. These were human agents. Think about patient access. For patient access, there are large provider teams that handle end-to-end appointment booking across, like in large hospitals, you would have a significant team of eight to 10 people handling appointment booking, rescheduling, and then automated follow-ups. On the benefits and eligibility, again, on the payer side as well as the provider side, you would have teams who are making these calls and those who are receiving these, giving out the right information. They have largely been humans who have been sitting in the loop, but I think with Sierra, this was a clear scenario where we could embed automated agents.

AI Interviewer 00:08:56

What were the decisive factors that led your organization to choose Sierra AI over the other vendors you evaluated?

Expert 00:09:03

A few things. One is humanness. Quite a few. One is maturity of the solution itself. Maturity, how long have they been in this specific niche? That's number one. Number two is humanness of these interactions. As what we've understood is when conversations are extremely robotic in nature, **it's difficult to hold** on to a conversation with a customer, a patient, a client, or even a provider. Humanness of voice, significantly lower latency, anything sub-700 ms in between conversations tend to start looking like or feeling more robotic in nature. When we evaluated, we actually measured latencies to ensure we had sub-500 ms, 500-millisecond latency in conversations, and then throughput.

Given when we are deploying, at any point in time, we could have 50, 60, 70, or 100 parallel live calls, connections going on, whether **the systems were able to scale without loss in performance and loss in fidelity of these calls**. Finally, we were also looking at capabilities that could handle multiple accents. Specifically in the healthcare setup, you're looking at solutions to manage or, rather, to understand, of course, typical U.S., but even within U.S. you have Latin accents and then South American accents. You have a lot of Asian population. Having good generalization in terms of performance or understanding of different accents was, again, one of the key use cases that we were trying to solve for with Sierra. Does that help?

AI Interviewer 00:10:45

Yes. How long did the evaluation process take from initial trigger to final vendor decision?

Expert 00:10:52

Roughly three months. We piloted with multiple vendors between, if I'm not mistaken, between July to September. That was a Q3 timeframe before finally narrowing down and then moving forward with signing, contracting, of course, a bit of negotiation, and then implementation.

AI Interviewer 00:11:11

Since deployment, has the strategic framing of Sierra AI shifted for your organization? For example, from tactical automation to something broader like a core AI interaction layer?

Expert 00:11:23

At our organization, we have an entire agentic platform, which has voice capabilities embedded to build agents. Sierra, of course, we have an alternative as well, but Sierra is one of the core voice capabilities or voice-enabled contact center capabilities that sit at a platform level for us. If the question is, has it moved beyond the point solution to being more a strategic choice in terms of what we are using, implementing within our product? Absolutely.

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AI Interviewer 00:11:52

Let's move to use cases. Beyond what you've described, are there any additional Sierra AI use cases deployed or seriously considered that we haven't touched on yet?

Expert 00:12:04

Are you talking of only the ones which are deployed or any others which we are also actively looking to implement?

AI Interviewer 00:12:10

Both, actually. What's deployed today and what's actively being considered for near-term implementation?

Expert 00:12:17

Got it. Actively deployed, absolutely. I think we have these outreach agents for any lead generation that our customer acquisition or pre-sales or the zero level pre-sales teams use. Those are areas that we use in. Second is in the RCM space for benefits and eligibility check that provider teams make out to payers and insurance health plans to understand if there is adequate coverage and eligibility and insurance availability for any patient walking into a provider setup. Third is in the referral and scheduling, patient access space. Handling end-to-end appointment booking, rescheduling, automated follow-ups, ensuring there are reduced no-shows. That is another area. These are three areas that we are effectively working on. Beyond these, there are more internal use cases.

One of them being in the hiring space. We are looking at, again, trying to build out a good capability to automate at least a few initial levels of the entire hiring process, the initial levels of filtering, screening candidates, making automated calls to understand profiles and understand initial skill sets and how well they match to job description so that we can screen them and then move them to additional rounds. I think that's one of the other internal use cases we are looking at. I think the first three that I spoke about have significant volume where we are maturing.

The one other area I would say is, initially, one or two of these were very pointed use cases, but now we have looked at embedding Sierra into our core platform offering, where when we deploy our platform into a health system, they can also, in parallel, our customers, they can build agents natively. They can build their own custom agents or custom voice agents on top of Sierra as well. That is an active motion where we are heading, but the first three are the ones which are more mature. Direct integration into our platform for enabling our customers to also use Sierra. That is a direction that we are heading in. Does that help?

AI Interviewer 00:14:29

Yes. For those first three deployed use cases, is Sierra.ai primarily completing tasks end-to-end autonomously, or does human review or intervention come into the workflow?

Expert 00:14:43

In the patient eligibility and verification check, that's pretty much end-to-end. Either it's end-to-end Sierra agent solving for it end-to-end, or if there is any confusion or the patient or the member or the payer at the other end, they want to interact actively with a human agent, then it's a handoff. That is definitely something which is otherwise completed automatically end-to-end. On the patient access scenario, referral and scheduling, that is, of course, with a human in the loop. It's a voice agent initiating the entire conversation, but the final calendar setup and confirming on the meeting, that is something where there is a human in the loop.

AI Interviewer 00:15:26

Where do handoffs or failures most commonly occur within those workflows?

Expert 00:15:30

Typically, we've seen failures with accent recognition. I think multi-accent recognition is one of the key areas. It's fairly complex to make a voice agent which is doing multiple hops to validate IDs. Let' say you have a patient ID and they need to validate their MRN number, and let's say it is a six- or seven-digit unique identification number. That kind of multi-step validation, whether it's a name, date of birth, multi-step unique ID sharing, if there is any other information. While they are very repetitive in nature, because it's multi-step, and very factual and objective, and if you fail at that step, of course, the entire workflow does not go forward. Those are some areas where **we've seen this failing**. One was about failures. The second is accents.

Like I said, multiple accents, like Asian accent versus something which is more Mandarin. Often we've seen voice models not having been trained with these in mind. **A lot of the initial implementations failed because they were** very good at only understanding U.S. accents and would fail when there would be other ethnicities or accents in play. Those were some of the failures. Handoffs, we've seen multiple cases where handoffs fail. I'm trying to recollect a few. One of them being when a call is going on, and you ask an agent to hand off to a human agent on the other side and not continue. We built in some scenarios where the voice agent itself would continue to suggest to

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continue the call.

It was a single step where we had said, try to convince the patient on the other line to continue with the agent and not necessarily move to a human agent. **We've seen a lot of falloff, calls getting dropped at that point in time, either when we dug in, it was this step going in a loop, and the patient or the member on the other end, or the caller on the other end was, with probably frustration**, dropped the call or did not want to. I would say it's more logical in terms of how we are defining pathways, but less in terms of the actual technology.

The one other scenario is the ability to capture when a user or a patient or a member says, "Hey, can you message me later?" Or, "Can you drop me a message on this?" Ensuring that we have an omnichannel setup along with voice where we are able to actively understand that the patient asked the system to send out a voice note or an email post this, and actually completing or covering off on that conversation. Those are some nuances that we are trying to ensure the entire system understands and reacts to, and ensuring that the entire conversation does not drop or hit a roadblock. Hope that was helpful.

AI Interviewer 00:18:26

That's very helpful. Let's move to implementation. From evaluation through initial value and broader production adoption, roughly how long did the full implementation timeline take, and were there **any major delays**?

Expert 00:18:40

We did a pilot for three months. Our initial build for the first agent took at least another two months at that point in time. Yes, while we built out our first agent in two months, **we did have to work very closely with Sierra and the support team to ensure voice tonality, communication, the reliability of pathways, accurate failback nodes**. That took significantly longer. We were thinking it would be a week or two weeks of back-and-forth support. It was already baked into our contract.

It's almost like maturing an entire pathway to ensure you are covering a lot of corner cases, edge cases. That took significantly longer. It was at least another close to a quarter, two and a half months before we could go to production. The technology setup, very quick. First agent build, just the build, very quick. It's just tuning, maturing flows, pathways, so that they can be used reliably in production is something **that was significantly more challenging**.

AI Interviewer 00:19:46

How was the burden of that tuning and maturation work split between Sierra.ai's team and your internal teams?

Expert 00:19:54

Given this is one of the first implementations we are doing with Sierra, I think we've baked it into the contract. Not only that, Sierra's own team also mentioned they wanted to have a few hours of the forward-deployed engineer working with us, and they also have somebody called a tonality engineer or speech engineer, working with us on a few hours every week to ensure we were successful. Otherwise, the contract or the technology itself was not going to be helpful until we could actually deploy these in production. I would say they did share significant ownership to ensure we were successful.

In terms of effort, it was a 70/30, 70% was our internal engineering team, support product team, working to understand and implement the nuances of pathways in our industry or setup or product. We had a dedicated support setup, Slack, email, everything set up and working with their team. We did get a 70/30 support with their team to help us out in this.

AI Interviewer 00:20:55

After that vendor-led onboarding, how self-sufficient is your team today in monitoring, tuning, and expanding Sierra.ai agents without Sierra's direct involvement?

Expert 00:21:05

I would say we've significantly matured with our understanding and usage of the platform. I would say roughly it's a 90/10 right now, where having built multiple pathways, **the team is significantly confident to handle** this on their own and continue to build additional pathways. We still have dedicated support gotten from Sierra or contacted from Sierra, where for any new use case, we do get at least a few hours of their FD or speech engineers onboarded to help with any developing or maturing any edge scenarios for the use cases that we are working on.

AI Interviewer 00:21:40

How have human agent roles or team workflows changed as a result of Sierra.ai adoption?

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Expert 00:21:47

Could you just double-click on this? I quite did not get the question. Do you mean it's on the product side? Could you share a little more on what you intend to understand?

AI Interviewer 00:22:00

Sure. For example, have human agent headcounts been reduced, or have their roles shifted to handling more complex tasks as Sierra.ai takes on routine interactions?

Expert 00:22:11

Yes. What we've tried to solve or even how we position, is less a reduction of human agents, but more the ability to handle larger scale, with the same headcount, larger or increased number of calls. Second, starting to have these specialized teams which handle complex scenarios. I think that has been a fundamental movement, and that is where this is heading to. The volume of calls, as **we've seen, do continue to increase** month on month. Historically, **team sizes have also grown linearly** to be able to handle these calls. With the advent of these technologies, that no longer needs to happen, number one.

Number two, given **the additional efficiency** that is brought into the system, the next step absolutely is where teams can dedicate some part or some bandwidth to complex or handling complex scenarios, handoffs, specific scenarios which need a patient to talk to a human agent on the other end, or scenarios which the pathways don't cover, specific persona groups, I think, high-risk patients. Those are scenarios where those are absolutely complex scenarios are handled off to human agents. I think **Sierra has significantly helped improve the efficiency metrics**. Hope that helps.

AI Interviewer 00:23:32

Yes, that's helpful. Let's move to performance and return on investment. Within ranges, what measurable outcomes has Sierra.ai delivered so far? For example, across resolution rate, containment, cost to serve, or customer satisfaction.

Expert 00:23:49

Can we take them one by one, please?

AI Interviewer 00:23:52

Of course. Starting with containment or deflection rate, what have you seen?

Expert 00:23:59

How would you define the deflection rate?

AI Interviewer 00:24:02

Sure. By containment or deflection, I mean the percentage of interactions Sierra.ai resolves fully without needing to transfer to a human agent. What range have you seen there?

Expert 00:24:15

Got it. Today that stands at almost, I would say, 65/35, 65% automated resolution, whereas 35% still need to go to a human agent.

AI Interviewer 00:24:27

What about cost to serve impact? Have **you been able to quantify any reduction in cost per interaction or** overall contact center costs?

Expert 00:24:36

It's the efficiency with 60% being handled by Sierra. Overall, **costs are projected to be reduced for contact center operations** because we may not need to hire more. Generally, as you're increasing the number of calls or as **you're expanding your business by 20%**, 25% every year, we have had to linearly increase our teams. Off the bat, I would say at least a 25%-30% because we're not having to increase teams with increasing business. I would say clearly **25%-30% efficiencies or cost gains** are something that we have significantly seen, that we have absolutely seen.

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AI Interviewer 00:25:13

Have you seen any measurable impact on customer satisfaction scores or net promoter score from Sierra.ai interactions?

Expert 00:25:22

Beyond just measuring increase in CSAT scores, I think when we deployed Sierra, our first goal was to ensure our CSAT scores were not dropping. I would say that in itself is a good first measure of success. Yes, I would say we've been able to maintain or manage our CSAT scores pretty much at the same level as they were pre-Sierra. Increase of CSAT scores, of course, **we saw an initial blip or a drop for a quarter**. That's where I think as we matured, made our pathways more robust, ensured multiple edge cases were covered off for. We've seen our entire CSAT scores come back to what they were pre-Sierra as well, which also is a good testament. Fundamentally, improvement of CSAT scores, not yet.

Possibly, this should ensure not just improvement of pathways with Sierra, probably better integration with systems, cleaner handoffs. Of course, it's a process. It should happen, but not something like significant bumps in CSAT score increase is not something we have seen. Just holding ground on what our pre-scores were, this is something that is already a testament to the fact that **we are doing a good job with Sierra**.

AI Interviewer 00:26:34

Which performance metrics are most trusted internally by finance or operations to justify continued investment in Sierra.ai?

Expert 00:26:43

Could you probably double-click on this question? I did not get it.

AI Interviewer 00:26:48

Sure. When it comes to justifying continued spend on Sierra.ai internally, which metrics does your finance or operations leadership find most credible? Are any of them contested or hard to attribute?

Expert 00:27:02

Our finance teams are effectively looking at headcount increase versus the number of calls that we've had to make. The deflection, we call it, our transfer rate, and whether that is **below** a 40% rate, which means our investments in Sierra are justified, where 60% of the calls that are meant to be taken by an agent, the agent is also able to complete end to end. Ensure that our transfer rates are low. The fact that we are not adding headcount at the same rate that we were previously. I think these are two clear metrics that our finance looks at to ensure or to confirm that we have significant ROI with our investments.

AI Interviewer 00:27:43

What has not worked as expected with Sierra AI so far?

Expert 00:27:47

I would say still there is significant work to be done in terms of multi-accent understanding or multi-accent responses. Often what we've seen is rather than only respond in a neutral accent, if Sierra immediately adopts to an accent which is similar to what the payer or what the user on the other end is talking to, we've seen significantly longer call times. Second is having additional metrics, improving the quality of metrics, which is around other member, what do you call it, tenacity of voice or emotion understanding metrics. Those are things that we would love for Sierra to improve in terms of the number of, and the quality of the metrics that they provide. I think these are two. Understanding support and quality of the product is something that we are okay with.

AI Interviewer 00:28:37

Has Sierra AI's value increased, plateaued, or declined as you've expanded use cases and volumes over time?

Expert 00:28:45

Sorry. Once again? I missed it.

AI Interviewer 00:28:49

Has the value Sierra AI delivers increased, plateaued, or declined as you've expanded to more use cases and higher volumes?

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Expert 00:28:58

It is increasing. I wouldn't say it's a massive, significant suddenly increase. I think year on year, quarter on quarter, we are definitely starting to look at additional use cases where we can embed and utilize Sierra. This is a space which, given there are infinite possibilities and pathways that can get explored whenever we are making a call, ensuring they stay within the guardrails, the right boundaries, **it's always been a little challenging**. Having said that, and hence, we are a little careful to not massively increase voice-based agents across, like strew them across the platform, but ensure that we are well-covered in that sense.

When we put one version of a pathway out, we allow it to mature and put significant support and feedback into the entire process to ensure it is working well before we move on to a new use case. Hence, I think the three use cases that we are onto right now are our core focus. Yes, I think they're exploring additional areas, but just being more careful and mindful of quality of each of these pathways, because at the other end, you are actually talking to a real customer and not necessarily an agent, so **that is one of the concerns** that we have. I hope that is helpful.

AI Interviewer 00:30:17

Let's move to pricing. How does your organization view Sierra AI's outcome-based pricing model in terms of alignment with value versus budget predictability?

Expert 00:30:27

I think that is very reasonable. I think the kind of product this is, **it's absolutely meant to disrupt largely how contact center**, access centers, patient access centers, referral scheduling on the healthcare side works, so we are comfortable with that, being a partner in terms of outcome-based pricing. As we are looking to bake this in into our platform, we intend to continue that pricing and pass it down to our customers as well.

AI Interviewer 00:30:52

How are successful outcomes defined and measured when it comes to what Sierra AI bills you for, and how do you forecast or audit that spend?

Expert 00:31:01

Got it. Sorry for the confusion. I think we are auditing that spend. Effectively, we have monitoring feedback, monitoring tools, in terms of number of minutes spent, how many calls are going out, month on month, quarter on quarter. I think we have the right tools and measurability in place. Of course, Sierra also provides its own tools. Beyond that outcome-based measurement is something that we also do. How many calls got completed? How many calls got dropped off? How much of an entire intent of a call was satisfied by, I think, the workflow versus what was done outside of that call by a human agent? These are things that we effectively measure.

Forecasting is significantly straightforward. You're looking at quarter-on-quarter measurements of increased calls, audit quality. Beyond, we do pass quality metrics or share quality metrics back with Sierra to ensure they are improving the product, which in turn improves our experience also, or our outcomes. These are definitely quality metrics that we are capturing.

AI Interviewer 00:32:12

Over the next 12 months, do you expect your Sierra AI spend to increase, stay flat, or decrease? What would drive that direction? What would be the primary driver of that increase?

Expert 00:32:27

We are seeing, of course, a quarter-on-quarter increase in terms of the number of calls. Like I said, **we do see an annual increase of the number of automated calls**, I would say 10%-20% year-on-year. Hence, **you would say a quarterly bump of 5%-6% calls,** or 3%-5% calls is what we are seeing. That is then what we factor in into our forecasting process.

AI Interviewer 00:32:55

Let's move to competitive positioning. Beyond Sierra.ai, what other AI agent or contact center AI alternatives did you evaluate? Are any still on an active shortlist?

Expert 00:33:07

We've looked at a few. We've looked at Bland.ai, which are still on our shortlist. We've looked at Yellow.ai. Of course, they did not have a fairly mature solution even a year back, but given they are one of our vendors in the omnichannel space, we intend to relook at their

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offerings. Bland, Yellow, the third is ElevenLabs. Again, ElevenAgents, pathways, it's not absolutely razor-focused on just customer outreach and access, but it's more generic as a platform, but that's the third one that we are looking at.

AI Interviewer 00:33:44

How does Sierra.ai compare to Bland.ai specifically, given it remains on your active shortlist?

Expert 00:33:52

Given Sierra's core expertise and focus in a particular domain or an area, it significantly is better. Lower latencies, better quality handoffs, more humanness of voice, I think these are things that we've seen **Sierra do significantly better than the other competitors**. Does that help?

AI Interviewer 00:34:11

Where do you see the biggest gap between Sierra.ai's marketing claims and actual production performance?

Expert 00:34:17

Like I said, one of the things is you can market that you are an extremely great voice agent vendor. Again, in production, you have multiple edge cases and multiple accent scenarios, multiple people working. **That is a bit of a challenge**. **I think handling multiple accents is definitely a key challenge that we've seen across all vendors, because a lot of these teams, companies, they've originated in the U.S. That's how their platforms work and hence, that is a challenge**. Their models are trained in a very U.S.-centric setup. The ability to handle multiple accents is something that is of significant interest that we'd want to look at.

AI Interviewer 00:34:57

Do you see **Sierra.ai becoming the core AI front door for customer interactions at your organization or remaining more of a tactical automation layer alongside your existing platforms**?

Expert 00:35:09

No, I think Sierra is definitely one of the core investments we are making in. Of course, this entire initiative started more tactical, getting into the space, but no, at this point, we are seeing it to be very core to what we are building.

AI Interviewer 00:35:26

What would be the biggest switching cost or disruption risk if you migrated away from Sierra.ai?

Expert 00:35:33

In building integration back into the system of record, EHR, and other systems, I think that would be one of the biggest costs. Second would be, of course, transfer of skill and learning of a new product or vendor.

AI Interviewer 00:35:46

How confident are you in Sierra.ai's roadmap, support quality, and reliability as signals of long-term durability?

Expert 00:35:54

I would say on a scale of 0-5, I would say four.

AI Interviewer 00:35:59

Finally, what specific product, performance, pricing, or strategic trigger would cause you to expand, reduce, or replace Sierra.ai?

Expert 00:36:10

If the models don't improve, if the latency is not at par with other competitive products, I think these are two core areas. Of course, if they are not supporting others really well, if they are not supporting other ethnicities, voice agents really well, or languages and accents really well, that would get me to move.

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AI Interviewer 00:36:29

Thanks for your insights today. Have a great rest of your day. Goodbye.

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